

Copilot data and workbook handling

Intro to Copilot in Excel | Updated September 25, 2026

Use the intended account

Use the account and Copilot experience approved for the task. Commercial Microsoft 365 protections should not be assumed to describe every consumer AI service or external connector.

Understand commercial data handling

Microsoft states that commercial Copilot prompts, responses and Microsoft Graph data are not used to train foundation language models. Interaction history can be retained and managed under organizational policies.

Review what enters the workbook

Work search respects access permissions. Information you can access can still be unsuitable for a shared report. Review the sources selected and the workbook audience before inserting content.

Treat web and connector sources separately

Web search and external services have their own data-handling boundaries. Check source settings and follow your organization's policy before sending information or approving a connector.

Keep control of edits

Allow editing can change the workbook directly. Practice on a copy, inspect the result, and use Undo or a prior saved version when necessary. Once saved, changes can be visible to other people with access.

Check the output

Verify important formulas, summaries and chart sources. Fluent explanations are not proof of accuracy. Workbook rules guide behavior but do not replace permissions or review.

For this webinar

Use the supplied practice data. Avoid opening private work files or personal conversations during a public demonstration. Ask your Microsoft 365 administrator about your organization's specific requirements.

Microsoft references

[Commercial Copilot data privacy and security](#)

[Enterprise data protection and web search](#)

[Web and work data sources](#)

[Access and licensing](#)